MARKETING AND ADVERTISING PROGRAM

Program Overview

The Bachelor of Business Administration with specialization in Marketing and Advertising is a program carefully designed to prepare graduates for successful careers in marketing communications in the media services and advertising industry. These careers require expertise in both marketing and advertising.

The program is founded on a general business and marketing core knowledge base, with additional technical and specialized knowledge drawn from and integrated across the main dimensions of marketing, advertising, public relations, and marketing communications.

To obtain a Bachelor of Business Administration degree in Marketing and Advertising, the student must complete 99 credit hours. These hours include University requirements (UR), College requirements (CR), and Program requirements (PR). The allocation of the credit hours is shown in the following table:

BBA in Marketing and Advertising (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Credits	28	3	56	12	99	100

I. University Requirements (General Education)

The list of the university's required courses and their descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section in this catalog.

II. College Requirements

The list of college-required courses and descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section of this catalog. Students in Marketing and Advertising take GRDS 220, Introduction to Digital Media, instead of BADM 420, Quantitative Methods for Business.

III. Program Requirements

A. Mandatory Requirements

The mandatory courses in the Marketing and Advertising program are listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
BMKA 310	Consumer Behavior	3	BMKA 200; Junior Standing
BMKA 365	Sales Management	3	BMKA 200; Junior Standing
BMKA 370	Marketing Research	3	BMKA 200, BADM 250
BMKA 380	Advertising Media and Strategies	3	BMKA 200
BMKA 430	Advertising Design and Creativity	3	GRDS 220, BMKA 350
BMKA 440	Social Media Marketing	3	Senior Standing
BMKA 485	Strategic Marketing	3	Senior Standing
	Major Elective	3	

B. Major Electives

As part of the Bachelor of Business Administration in Marketing and Advertising program, the student must study 3 credit hours of major electives. Major electives could be upper-level courses in Marketing and Advertising or closely related business areas. These courses allow students to focus on a specific area for in-depth knowledge and understanding. Meanwhile, they introduce flexibility into the program, allowing the integration of emerging topics.

In consultation with the academic advisor, the student should select the elective course that best aligns with their needs and aspirations. It is highly recommended that the student register for these courses after completing the Departmental requirements. The table below lists some recommendations for major elective courses:

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BADM 480	Independent Studies	3	Advisor's approval
BMGT 300	Project Management	3	Junior standing
BMKA 320	Introduction to Public Relations	3	BMKA 200
BMKA 405	Media Planning Analysis and Management	3	Senior Standing
BMKA 450	Events Marketing and Management	3	Senior Standing

Moreover, under certain conditions specified by the department and subject to the advisor's approval, a student may take BADM 480 (independent studies) as a substitute for a program's mandatory course. The course's description is below.

C. Entrepreneurship

The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. Prerequisite: Senior Standing.

D. Co-op Work Experience

Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. The Co-op experience is usually fulfilled during the Summer Semester of the third year in the program. The Co-op office matches the Co-op assignment with the student's field of study and the employer's interest. A faculty member follows up on a student's progress throughout the Co-op period by conducting field visits to ensure that the student's performance is aligned with their aspirations and the employer's needs. Students are then required to submit formal reports and posters and make formal presentations about their Co-op experience. While ENGL 217 and Senior Standing are the essential prerequisites for co-op training, the program may stipulate additional conditions.

Career Opportunities

The program opens the doors to a range of career possibilities in media, advertising, and marketing communications. Career opportunities include such positions as account executive, communications and media planner, advertising and promotion manager, sales manager, brand manager, and marketing manager.

Program Goals and Student Learning Outcomes

The purpose of the Marketing and Advertising Program at the College of Business Administration of Rafik Hariri University is an integrative composite of four main dimensions: General and Specialized Business Knowledge, Communication, Critical Thinking, and Growth Potential.

General & Specialized Business Knowledge

Goal 1	Prepare graduates to demonstrate an effective level of professional competence in conducting critical business activities, particularly those related to marketing and advertising.
Outcome 1	Apply essential business knowledge and skills in problem-solving and decision-making.
Outcome 2	Develop integrated marketing communication strategies through advertising designs, promotional approaches, and media plans.

Communication

Goal 2	Equip graduates with the knowledge and skills to secure placements in financial and managerial accounting positions.

Outcome 3	Demonstrate written and oral English communication skills adequate for challenging entry- and middle-level professional positions and/or self-employment.

Critical Thinking

Goal 3	Promote analytical and critical thinking in approaching business issues and problems.
Outcome 4	Identify business problems, analyze them, and present plausible solutions.

Ethics and Social Responsibility

Goal 4	Raise awareness about ethics and social responsibility to promote better business for a better community.
Outcome 5	Recognize ethical dilemmas in business and respond to them in accordance with standard codes of conduct, ethical principles, and best practices.

Study Plan

The Bachelor of Business Administration in Marketing and Advertising comprises 99 credit hours spread over 6 semesters and 2 summer sessions. The first summer session should be dedicated to the Community Engagement Experience. Meanwhile, the second session should be for the Co-op work experience. The following study plan serves as a roadmap for a smooth progression toward graduation.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
Year 1, Fall Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 205	Financial Accounting	3	
BADM 215	Personal Development and Management	1	
BITM 200	Information Technology Essentials	3	
BMGT 200	Introduction to Management	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210
ENGL 210	English Composition and Rhetoric	3	Placement
MATH 207	College Algebra*	3	Placement
Year 1, Spring Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 255	Managerial Accounting	3	BACC 205
BADM 225	Business Math	3	Placement
BADM 235	Business Research Methodology	1	
BADM 250	Business Statistics	3	
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req. ENGL 210
ENGL 217	Professional English Communication	3	ENGL 210
Year 2, Fall Semester (18 Credits)			
BADM 230	Business Law	3	
BECN 301	Microeconomics	3	Junior Standing

BFIN 300	Financial Management I	3	BACC 205
BITM 300	Business IT Management	3	BITM 200
BMKA 310	Consumer Behavior	3	BMKA 200; Junior Standing
	Science Elective	3	
Year 2, Spring Semester (18 Credits)			
BECN 302	Macroeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BITM 350	Fundamentals of Data Analytics	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351.
BMKA 370	Marketing Research	3	BMKA 200, BADM 250
BMKA 380	Advertising Media and Strategies	3	BMKA 200
GRDS 220	Introduction to Digital Media	3	
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 2, Summer Semester (0 Credit)			
BADM 290	Community Engagement Experience	0	
Year 3, Fall Semester (15 Credits)			
ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2	
BMKA 430	Advertising Design and Creativity	3	GRDS 220; BMKA 380
BMKA 440	Social Media Marketing	3	Senior Standing
	Community & Sustainability	1	Co-req.: ENGL 210
	Major Elective	3	
	Humanities / Fine Arts Elective	3	
Year 3, Spring Semester (15 Credits)			
BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3	Junior Standing
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
BMKA 365	Sales Management	3	BMKA 200 and Junior Standing
BMKA 485	Strategic Marketing	3	Senior Standing
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Summer Semester (1 Credit)			
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing

* Students exempted from this course based on their score on the mathematics placement exam will select a free elective course as a substitute for it.

Courses Description

I. Mandatory Courses

Descriptions of the major mandatory courses are given below.

BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1(1,0)
The Co-op work experience is designed to provide students with a full-time work term in business, industry, or government. The main thrust of this course is the opportunity to put into practice the major aspects of the student's business education. Special emphasis will be placed on assessing the attitude and work ethics of the "co-op" student. Students will be encouraged to network in the industry and to participate in professional organizations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 217; Senior Standing.		

BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3(3,0)
The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.		

BMKA 310	Consumer Behavior	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the world of consumer behavior. Students explore how perceptions, learning, memory, personality, and attitudes influence consumption behavior. They learn how consumption changes during one's life cycle and how powerful cultural and subcultural factors influence consumers. Theories and case study analysis are applied throughout the course. **Prerequisites**: BMKA 200; Junior Standing		

BMKA 365	Sales Management	3(3,0)
Rapidly changing market conditions and customers' expectations are redefining the roles of salespeople and the sales process within a modern framework. This course helps students understand and apply practical interpersonal techniques and persuasive communication strategies in the selling process. It focuses on value-added techniques that are based on four broad strategic areas. The concepts of customer value and building and retaining long-term relationships are integrated throughout the course. **Prerequisites**: BMKA 200 and Junior Standing.		

BMKA 370	Marketing Research	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to marketing research and its role in the marketing decision-making planning process. It explains the principles of the marketing research process and helps students apply them to real-life marketing problems and opportunities. The course will conclude with students submitting a marketing research project in which they identify a marketing problem/opportunity, develop a research methodology, and collect and analyze data using IBM SPSS© Statistics software. Students will learn how to present their research results, make appropriate interpretations, and provide recommendations based on their analysis. **Prerequisites**: BMKA 200; BADM 250.		

BMKA 380	Advertising Media and Strategies	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the role of advertising in the business world from both theoretical and applied perspectives. It outlines the structure of the advertising		

industry and focuses on the advertising and communication process, message and creative strategy development, and campaign design. The course endorses an integrated marketing communications perspective, in which students learn strategic media planning, buying, management, and evaluation for advertising purposes. **Prerequisite:** BMKA 200

BMKA 430	**Advertising Design and Creativity**	**3(3,0)**
In this course, students explore and apply principles of graphic design to solve appropriate marketing and advertising problems. The design process is approached from both the creative and business perspectives. Students learn to develop advertising concepts and ideas and transform them into effective print ads, brochures, and online communications. Case studies from broadcast and outdoor media, print ads, and digital marketing channels showcase advertising concepts at work: persuasion, color psychology, composition, copywriting, and typography. **Prerequisites:** GRDS 220; BMKA 380		

BMKA 440	**Social Media Marketing**	**3(3,0)**
Social media marketing has become an essential component of modern marketing communications in a dynamic and customer-centric environment. This course is designed to help students master the essential skills of building social media communication strategies, managing different social media channels, and measuring and reporting results. **Prerequisite**: Senior Standing.		

BMKA 485	**Strategic Marketing**	**3(3,0)**
This course explores in depth the concepts and methods of the strategic marketing planning process. Drawing heavily on real-world marketing case studies, it covers market situational analysis, marketing strategies, and tactics for building and sustaining competitive advantage. The course concludes by developing and presenting a marketing plan**. Prerequisite**: Senior Standing.		

II. Elective Courses

Descriptions of some major elective courses are given below.

BADM 480	**Independent Studies**	**3(3,0)**
This course focuses on advancing the student's knowledge in their area of specialization through independent research and/or application work on current or emerging topics, as approved by the assigned faculty member. **Prerequisite:** Advisor's approval.		

BMGT 300	**Project Management**	**3(3,0)**
This course provides students with the skills to manage their business projects by effectively leading, organizing, scheduling, and controlling tasks to achieve project goals. Topics include project selection and statement of work; project managers' skills and task breakdown structure; PERT/CPM scheduling; and budgeting. **Prerequisite:** Junior Standing.		

BMKA 320	Introduction to Public Relations	3(3,0)
This course introduces students to the strategies and tactics of modern public relations practices. It explains the basic concepts and theories of public relations by examining campaigns of well-known companies, institutions, and individuals. In addition, the course explains how to plan, develop, and evaluate public relations campaigns using a wide variety of communication tools. **Prerequisite:** BMKA 200.		

BMKA 405	Media Planning, Analysis, and Management	3(3,0)
This course introduces critical and strategic media planning and evaluation for advertising purposes. The course emphasizes the principles of media planning, buying, and management. Students will study audience measurement, media research, audience segmentation, and advertising strategies. **Prerequisite:** BMKA 380.		

BMKT 450	Events Marketing and Management	3(3,0)
This course covers the skills and concepts necessary to create, manage, market, and finance special events. It provides a conceptual overview and systematic study of event marketing and management. Additionally, it fosters professionalism, coordination, and collaboration among team members to achieve the objectives of special events. The course concludes with the implementation and evaluation of a special event. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.		